

The Scientific Method

Scientists often follow steps like these. Real investigations rarely run straight through - you may loop back, change something and test again.

Name _____ Date _____

- ① **Ask a question** Something you can actually test.

- ② **Find out what is known** Books, websites, a teacher.

- ③ **Write a hypothesis** A testable idea, not just a guess.

- ④ **Plan a fair test** Change one thing; keep the rest the same.

- ⑤ **Observe and record** Measure carefully and write it down.

- ⑥ **Look for patterns** What does the data show?

- ⑦ **Conclude and share** Answer the question. Say what you would do differently.
